

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠4

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠4

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥6

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♦

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠K

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ J 10 9 4
♦ 9
♣ 10 8 6 4 2

♠ K J 2
♥ Q 7 5
♦ Q 10 7 2
♣ 7 5 3



♠ 7 4 3
♥ 8 3 2
♦ J 6 5 4 3
♣ A 9

♠ Q 10 8 5
♥ A K 6
♦ A K 8
♣ K Q J

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠4			

SOUTH expected to open 2♣, then bid 2NT at her second turn.

But NORTH, with 8 points and a balanced hand, responds 2NT, so SOUTH must adapt. She shows her minimum, balanced, 22-point hand by bidding 3NT.

Since SOUTH has just the 8 points minimum that he promised, he passes 3NT.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9 8 7
♥ Q J 8 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ 7 4

♠ 10 3

♥ 10 7 6 3

♦ 5 4

♣ J 10 9 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q J 2

♥ A K 5

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ A 6

♠ 6 5 4

♥ 9 4

♦ A J 10 2

♣ K Q 5 2

EAST has a balanced 23-point hand. He opens 2♣.

With 6 points and two 4-card Majors, WEST can only say 2♦.

EAST shows his minimum hand with a 2NT rebid.

Now WEST bids 3♣. This is not the second negative, but rather it is Stayman.

When EAST shows his ♠ suit WEST bids 4♠.

West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by East			
Lead: ♠4			

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6 5 4 3

♥ 10 6 3

♦ 3

♣ Q 8 6 2

♠ A 8

♥ K Q 4

♦ A K Q J 8 6

♣ K 4



♠ Q J 10

♥ J 8 2

♦ 9 5 4

♣ J 10 9 7

♠ K 7 2

♥ A 9 7 5

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A 5 3

NORTH opens 2♣.

SOUTH should just respond 2NT, even with 11 points. The idea is to make a positive response (which forces the partnership to game level), and show extra strength later.

This time there is no need. NORTH should bid 4♣ (Gerber), and SOUTH answers 4♠ for two Aces.

Next NORTH should ask for Kings, and when SOUTH shows one King NORTH should bid 7NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♥6			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 7 3

♥ 6 2

♦ Q J 9 8 6 3

♣ A 4

♠ A K Q 10 2

♥ 7 4

♦ 10 4

♣ 10 8 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8

♥ A K Q 5

♦ A K 7 2

♣ K Q J 3

♠ J 6 5 4

♥ J 10 9 8 3

♦ 5

♣ 9 5 2

*West**North**East**South*

3♦

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♦

Pass

6♦

All Pass

6♦ by West

Lead: ♠K

When EAST opens 2♣ WEST has enough strength (9 points) for a positive response. But, because her suit is ♦s, she must jump to 3♦.

EAST thinks slam and uses Blackwood to discover that WEST holds one Ace.

That's all WEST needs to know to bid 6♦.